Equipment Quickstart

A useful record in 15 minutes

1. IDENTIFY

Assign a stable name such as Plant A. Record the date, growth stage if known, medium, container and location. Write unknown when information is missing.

2. PHOTOGRAPH

Take a whole-plant view, a close view of the concern, and an underside view where relevant. Keep the original files.

3. RECORD

Write what you see before asking AI. Example: two lower leaves look lighter than yesterday. Do not start with a diagnosis.

4. ASK AND CHECK

Ask for observations, alternative explanations, and the missing facts needed to distinguish them. Save the response separately from your own verified notes.

Photographs AI can use

Three views, one observation

WHOLE PLANT

Include the container and distribution of the concern. A close-up alone cannot establish whether a change affects one leaf or the whole plant.

DETAIL

Use even light, steady the phone, tap to focus, and inspect the saved image at full size. Keep the relevant edge or vein inside the frame.

COMPARISON

Use the same plant area, distance and lighting at the next observation. Record any change in camera or light conditions.

QUALITY CHECK

Accept: the feature is in focus and visible. Retake: motion blur, colored-light cast, clipped feature or deep shadow. Do not ask AI to recover detail that the image never captured.

Record temperature and humidity

A number needs a location and time

MINIMUM RECORD

Time; device; air temperature with unit; relative humidity in percent; sensor location; light on/off; time allowed to stabilize. Record the display, not a rounded memory.

EXAMPLE

08:00 | Sensor A | 24.1 C | 58% RH | beside canopy, shaded from direct light | lights on | reading stable. This is an example record, not a recommended target.

A MEANINGFUL COMPARISON

Repeat with the same device and placement. Moving a sensor can explain a changed number. Document the move before interpreting a trend.

DEVICE LIMITS

Check the manual for placement, operating range and calibration. A cheap meter reading is not automatically a calibrated reference.

Reusable observation sheet

Print or copy this page

IDENTITY

Date / time: _____ Plant ID: _____
Image filenames: _____

EVIDENCE

What I can see: _____
Measurements + units: _____
Device / placement / conditions: _____

REVIEW

AI suggestion: _____
Verified facts: _____
Unknowns / rejected claims: _____

NEXT CHECK

What I will observe next: _____
When / comparable method: _____